

Money matters

Adolescence is a great time to learn how to take responsibility for personal money. Teens can start to earn an allowance for chores or get a part-time job, so it's a good idea to learn how to set a budget, have a bank account, and start saving.

Making a budget

A budget is an estimate of how much money will be coming in and going out in the future. A good budget is based on realistic predictions. Teens should start by working out and writing down what money they receive from an allowance and any part-time jobs they have. They should then write down purchases that are essential, such as school supplies. If there is money left over after these expenses, this can be saved up for things that count as luxury purchases, such as video games or music.

▽ Compare prices

Try to be savvy when making purchases by shopping around—price comparison websites are quick and reliable, and can save users money.

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TEEN HINTS

Allowance

An allowance is a great way to start gaining financial independence. Ask your parents if you can earn some money by doing chores at home. Then, once you've started earning, work out a budget and try to stick to it. If your budget works properly, you should be able to save money and buy yourself the things you really want.



Free things to do

People don't have to spend a lot of money to have fun. There are many things teens can do that won't cost anything. Spending time in the local library, swapping clothes with friends, visiting galleries and museums, window shopping at the mall, going to free concerts in public spaces, or playing in the park are just a few ideas.

